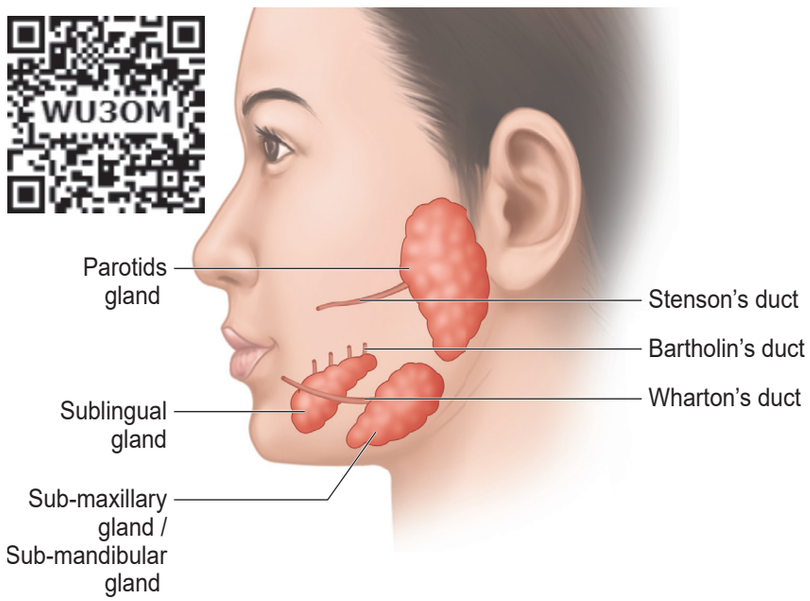


Figure 5.6 Salivary glands

Though the bile juice of liver has no digestive enzyme but is very essential for proper digestion of food, especially of the fats. Discuss the following?

a) What is composition of bile?
b) How it helps in digestion of fats and other nutrients of food?
c) How it helps in absorption of fats?

tissue sheath called the **Glisson's capsule**. Liver cells (hepatic cells) secrete bile which is stored and concentrated in a thin muscular sac called the gall bladder. The duct of gall bladder (cystic duct) along with the hepatic duct from the liver forms the common bile duct. The bile duct passes downwards and joins with the main pancreatic duct to form a common duct called hepato-pancreatic duct. The opening of the hepato-pancreatic duct into the duodenum is guarded by a sphincter called the **sphincter of Oddi** (Figure.5.7). Liver has high power of regeneration and liver cells are replaced by new ones every 3-4 weeks.

Apart from bile secretion, the liver also performs several functions

1. Destroys aging and defective blood cells
2. Stores glucose in the form of glycogen or disperses glucose into the blood stream with the help of pancreatic hormones
3. Stores fat soluble vitamins and iron
4. Detoxifies toxic substances.
5. Involves in the synthesis of non-essential amino acids and urea.

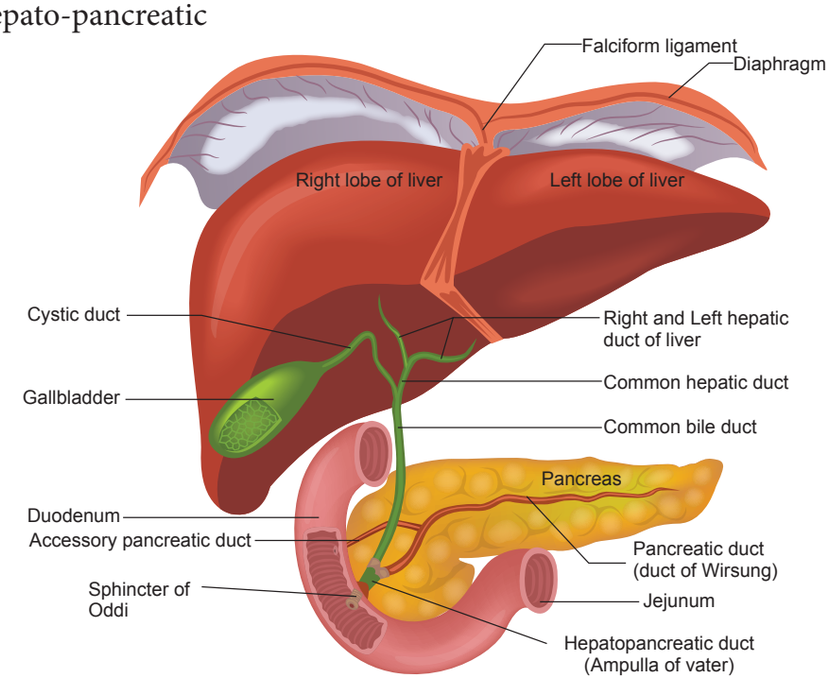


Figure 5.7 Liver and pancreas

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